LAF YOMI

Bekhorot 35 · October 23, 2026

ON TODAY'S DAF

Bekhorot 35: the קנסו בנו אחריו finale (does the kenas reach the son? chametz she'avar alav haPesach? — cue the office scotch), the mishnah's two stories (the quaestor, the tail-tying kids), לדעת vs. שלא לדעת, the kicked chasing bechor, pre-birth mumim, and the kohen-shepherd credibility matrix.

MISHNAH'S STORIES · THE CHILDREN'S TAIL-TYING GAME



1. *The mishnah: פעם אחת היו תינוקות משחקין בשדה — kids tied the tails of two lambs together. One tail snapped clean off — and naturally, it was a bechor.*

“Children used to have different games than they have nowadays — they'd tie the tails of two sheep together so they'd run in different directions.' The kids were 'just playing this very disturbing game' — no intent to make a mum, so the chachamim were matir.”

— Rabbi Lebowitz

In the daf: Bekhorot 35a · פעם אחת היו תינוקות משחקין בשדה — the kids' tail-tying game · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Aryeh Lebowitz · 16:02

קנסו בנו אחריו · THE AGED OFFICE-SCOTCH PROBLEM



2. *Rav Menashe Klein: the lawyer's l'chaim from his partner's high-end scotch — the bottle's sat there for years, definitely chametz she'avar alav haPesach. What's the limud zechut?*

“It 'never occurred to him,' the lawyer said, that the aged scotch was chametz she'avar alav haPesach. Rav Menashe Klein's limud zechut: a mumar's chametz may never become asur — the gezeira targets people who get lazy about biur, not 'someone who could care less.”

— Rabbi Lebowitz

In the daf: Bekhorot 35a · קנסו בנו אחריו — the office-scotch limud zechut · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Aryeh Lebowitz · 12:58

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היה בכור רודפו · THE SELF-DEFENSE KICK THAT CAME TOO LATE



3. The mishnah: a bechor is chasing you to gore you, so you kick it and it gets a mum — you may shecht it. Rav Pappa: only if you kicked during the chase. Kick it after the chase is over, and the mum doesn't help you.

“I might have thought: צעריה הוא דמדכר — he's letting out his frustration. This animal scared me, it terrified me — I wasn't thinking rationally!' Rav Pappa: nice try. Once the chase is over, the kick counts.”

— Rabbi Lebowitz

In the daf: Bekhorot 35a · the רודפו debate — צעריה הוא דמדכר, or just kicking a bechor? · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Aryeh Lebowitz · 22:23

שלא לדעת מותר · THE HELPFUL EXTRA-WATER GUY



4. The Terumas Hadeshen: blood fell into water — asur, and there weren't shishim to be mevatel it. The owner set the bowl aside to spill out. Then a helpful soul came along and poured in more water.

“Elefant: 'He thought that this was water that they needed to wash the floor or whatever with, and he wanted more water so he poured more water into it.' Zero intent to be mevatel the issur — the mixture is mutar. Same for wormy flour, ground unknowingly.”

— Rabbi Elefant

In the daf: Bekhorot 35a · שלא לדעת לאתויי מסיח לפי תומו — 'I was just adding water' · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Moshe Elefant · 5:10

לא שבק צורבא מרבנן · THE ETERNAL SEARCH FOR A BIGGER TALMID CHACHAM



5. Why is a kohen-shepherd believed about a Yisrael's bechor? 'Why in the world would he give his bechor to me, a little shepherd? He'd give it to a talmid chacham!'

“The Chacham Tzvi: the shepherd always got the bechorim — doesn't track record prove he'll get this one? No: the Yisrael is 'always on the lookout for a bigger talmid chacham.' Raya: switch mohels for a greater one — past gifts create no rights.”

— Rabbi Elefant

In the daf: Bekhorot 35b · לא שבק צורבא מרבנן ויהיב לדידי — and your mohel's job security · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Moshe Elefant · 30:35